Internal Escalation Directory & Standard Operating Procedures (SOP) Handbook

Edition: Q1 2026 • Maintained by: Global Enterprise Operations Center (GEOC) • Audience: All Employees & Engineering Teams

Section 1. Who to Contact: Master Internal Support & Escalation Directory

When employees encounter technical, administrative, security, or facilities issues, routing the request to the designated support desk ensures fast resolution within established Service Level Agreements (SLAs). Below is the authoritative directory of contacts, Slack channels, ServiceNow queues, and named escalation leads.

1.1 IT Workstation Helpdesk & Hardware Support

- **Primary Contact Scope:** Laptop hardware failures, locked W3 SSO passwords, YubiKey replacement, macOS/Windows/Linux OS crashes, Cisco VPN client installation, and monitor/peripheral replacements.
- **Slack Channel:** `#it-helpdesk-global` (24/7 automated triage bot + live engineers)
- **ServiceNow Portal & Email:** `https://w3.ibm.internal/it-support` • `it-helpdesk@ibm.internal`
- **24/7 Emergency Phone Hotline:** `+1-888-555-0140` (Americas) / `+40-21-555-0140` (EMEA Hub)
- **Escalation Lead:** Marcus Vance, Director of Global Endpoint Support (`mvance@ibm.internal`)
- **Response SLA: 15 minutes** for Urgent work-stoppage lockouts; **4 business hours** for standard software tickets; **Next-Business-Day courier swap** for defective laptops.

1.2 IBM Db2 Database Administration & Vector Platform Reliability (DBA Team)

- **Primary Contact Scope:** Provisioning staging/production IBM Db2 instances, tuning 32 KB vector tablespaces, resolving `SQL30081N` / `SQL0964C` transaction log full errors, backup restoration, and HADR cluster failover.
- **Slack Channel:** `#db2-platform-support` (for general queries) and `#db2-prod-urgent` (for production database incidents)
- **ServiceNow Queue & Email:** Assignment Group `DBA-CORE-DB2` • `db2-ops-oncall@ibm.internal`
- **PagerDuty Hotline (Sev-1/Sev-2 Only):** `+1-888-555-0199` (triggers immediate page to the primary and secondary on-call Principal DBA)
- **Principal Lead DBA:** Dr. Elena Rostova, Distinguished Engineer, Db2 Data Platform (`erostova@ibm.internal`)

- **Response SLA: 10 minutes** for Sev-1 Production Database Outages; **2 business hours** for staging schema/tablespace requests.

1.3 Cybersecurity Incident Response Team (CSIRT) & InfoSec

- **Primary Contact Scope:** Stolen or lost corporate laptops/phones, suspected phishing emails clicked, accidental exposure of API keys or credentials in GitHub, unauthorized database access alerts, and DDoS/intrusion events.
- **Slack Channel:** `#security-incident-911` (monitored 24/7/365 by SOC analysts)
- **Emergency Reporting Portal & Email:** `https://w3.ibm.internal/csirt-report` • `csirt-emergency@ibm.internal` (Phishing forward address: `phish-report@ibm.internal`)
- **24/7 Security Operations Center (SOC) Hotline:** `+1-800-555-0911`
- **Escalation Lead:** Rajesh Patel, VP of Cyber Defense & Incident Response (`rpatel.sec@ibm.internal`)
- **Mandatory Reporting Rule:** Lost or stolen hardware or leaked credentials must be reported to CSIRT within **1 hour of discovery**.

1.4 Human Resources, Global Mobility, Payroll & Finance Contacts

- **People & HR Policy Desk (PTO, Leaves, Benefits):** Slack `#ask-hr-support` • Email `askhr@ibm.internal` • Lead: Clara Lindqvist (`clindqvist@ibm.internal`) • SLA: **24 business hours**.
- **Global Mobility & International Remote Work Desk (Working from Abroad Approvals):** Portal `w3.ibm.internal/mobility-request` • Slack `#global-mobility-tax` • Email `global-mobility@ibm.internal` • Lead: David Thorne (`dthorne.tax@ibm.internal`) • SLA: **5 business days** for Tier-1 requests.
- **Payroll & Tax Withholding Desk:** Slack `#payroll-help` • Email `payroll-inquiries@ibm.internal` • Lead: Sophia Chen (`schen.fin@ibm.internal`) • Cut-off rule: Payroll adjustments must be received by the **18th of each month** to reflect in that month's cycle.
- **Concur Travel & Expense Audit Desk:** Slack `#concur-expense-help` • Email `expense-audit@ibm.internal` • Corporate Amex Card Freeze/Support: `+1-800-555-0177`.
- **Open-Source, IP & Legal Contract Review Desk:** Slack `#legal-oss-clearance` • Email `oss-legal-review@ibm.internal` • Lead: Hannah Sterling, Senior IP Counsel (`hsterling@ibm.internal`).

Section 2. Standard Operating Procedures (SOPs) for Core Workflows

> **Critical SOP Summary — Production Sev-1 Incidents (SOP-001):** Any production outage affecting customer-facing APIs, authentication, or Db2 databases is classified as **Severity 1 (Sev-1)**. The discovering engineer must trigger a PagerDuty incident within **5 minutes**, open an automated war-room channel (`#inc-YYYYMMDD-short-slug`), join the bridge within **10 minutes**, post status updates every **30 minutes**, and deliver a blameless Root Cause Analysis (RCA) document within **48 hours** of resolution.

2.1 SOP-001: Production Incident Triage and War-Room Escalation

All production software and database incidents are categorized into four severity levels with strict response and communication timelines:

1. **Severity 1 (Critical Outage / Data Integrity Risk):** Complete outage of a production service, critical authentication failure, or primary Db2 database unavailability affecting external customers or more than 20% of internal users.
   • *Action Step 1 (0–5 Minutes):* Trigger `/pd trigger sev1 <service-name>` in Slack, which pages the On-Call Incident Commander (IC), Service Owner, and DBA Lead, and automatically creates `#inc-YYYYMMDD-<id>` plus a Webex/Teams voice bridge.
   • *Action Step 2 (5–15 Minutes):* The Incident Commander assigns a Communications Lead (`Comms Lead`) and Operations Lead (`Ops Lead`). If root cause is linked to a recent deployment, execute an immediate rollback before attempting forward fixes.
   • *Action Step 3 (Every 30 Minutes):* The Comms Lead updates the executive status page (`status.ibm.internal`) every **30 minutes** until service restoration.
   • *Action Step 4 (Within 48 Hours Post-Resolution):* The engineering squad publishes a written Blameless Post-Mortem & RCA in Confluence (`w3.ibm.internal/postmortems`) with Jira action items assigned to prevent recurrence.
2. **Severity 2 (Major Degradation):** Partial feature degradation or elevated API latency (> 2,500 ms p95) with an available workaround. Initial response SLA: **30 minutes**; status updates every **2 hours**.
3. **Severity 3 (Minor Issue) & Severity 4 (Cosmetic / Documentation):** Handled during standard business hours with a **1-business-day** and **5-business-day** triage SLA respectively.

2.2 SOP-002: Production Change Management & Deployment Freeze Windows

To prevent uncoordinated production changes from causing outages, all production database schema migrations and microservice deployments must follow `SOP-002`:

- **Standard Automated Change (`CHG-STD`):** Pre-approved for zero-downtime stateless service deployments that pass 100% of automated canary and regression gates during allowed deployment hours (**Monday through Thursday, 08:00 to 16:00 local data-center time**).
- **Normal Production Change (`CHG-NORM` — Required for Db2 Schema Alterations):** Any production `ALTER TABLE`, index rebuild, or configuration change requires submitting a ServiceNow Change Request at least **48 hours in advance** and presenting it at the Change Advisory Board (CAB) meeting held every **Tuesday and Thursday at 14:00 UTC**.
- **Friday & Quarter-End Change Freeze Rule:** Production deployments are strictly prohibited on **Fridays after 12:00 UTC**, on weekends, and during the **last 5 calendar days of every fiscal quarter** (Quarter-End Blackout), unless an Emergency Change (`CHG-EMERG`) is signed off by the VP of Engineering and Incident Commander to remediate an active Sev-1 incident or critical zero-day CVE.

2.3 SOP-003: Accidental Credential or Secret Leak Remediation

If an engineer accidentally commits an API key, Db2 password, SSH private key, or customer token to a Git branch or Slack channel, rewriting Git history (`git push --force`) is **not sufficient** because automated bots and mirrors index commits within seconds. Follow this mandatory 4-step sequence immediately:

1. **Step 1 — Revoke & Rotate Immediately (Within 15 Minutes):** Log into the issuing console (IBM Cloud IAM, GitHub Settings, or Db2 admin console) and immediately revoke/deactivate the exposed credential before doing anything else.
2. **Step 2 — Notify CSIRT (Within 30 Minutes):** Post the repository URL, commit SHA, and timestamp of revocation in `#security-incident-911` or via `w3.ibm.internal/csirt-report` so the SOC team can audit access logs during the exposure window.
3. **Step 3 — Purge Commit from GitHub Enterprise Cache:** Open a ticket with the GitHub Enterprise Admin queue (`GHE-ADMIN-SEC`) to run `git-filter-repo` and purge cached commit objects from server reflogs.
4. **Step 4 — Update `.secrets.baseline`:** Verify why the local `detect-secrets` pre-commit hook did not block the commit and update the repository baseline.

2.4 SOP-004: Third-Party SaaS & Open-Source Library Procurement

Before introducing any new open-source library not currently cached in `artifactory.ibm.internal` or purchasing a third-party SaaS tool:

- **Open-Source License Rules:** Libraries licensed under permissive licenses (**Apache 2.0, MIT, BSD-2-Clause, BSD-3-Clause**) are pre-approved for internal and commercial distribution once scanned by Mend/Snyk. Libraries licensed under strong copyleft licenses (**GPL v2/v3, AGPL v3, or SSPL**) are **strictly prohibited** from being linked into proprietary codebases or hosted SaaS services without an explicit written exception from the Senior IP Counsel (`oss-legal-review@ibm.internal`).
- **SaaS & Vendor Onboarding Under/Over $10,000 USD:** Software subscriptions costing up to **$10,000 USD per year** require Department Director approval and a Lite Security Assessment (`SEC-VEND-LITE`, 5-business-day turnaround). Any software or vendor contract exceeding **$10,000 USD per year** or processing `L3-CONFIDENTIAL` data requires a full Procurement RFP in Ariba (`w3.ibm.internal/ariba`), a comprehensive Vendor Risk Assessment (`SEC-VEND-FULL`), and a signed Data Processing Addendum (DPA).